(Rev. 5-10)

IMPORTANT INFORMATION FOR CHARITABLE ORGANIZATIONS

The information, that follows, is not all-inclusive. You are encouraged to obtain a complete copy of the Solicitation of Funds for Charitable Purposes Act and registration forms by contacting the Bureau or by printing the information from our website at: www.dos.state.pa.us/char.

ELECTRONIC FILING OPTION: You can file electronically by visiting the Bureau's Web site or http://efile.form990.org.

REQUIRED DISCLOSURE STATEMENT: Section 13 of the Solicitation of Funds for Charitable Purposes Act, 10 P. S. § 162.13, requires that the following statement be conspicuously printed **verbatim** on every printed solicitation or written confirmation, receipt, and reminder of a contribution:

> **The official registration and financial information of [insert the legal name of your charitable organization as registered with the Department] may be obtained from the Pennsylvania Department of State by calling toll-free, within Pennsylvania, 1-800-732-0999. Registration does not imply endorsement.**

REQUIREMENT TO UPDATE INFORMATION: Organizations are required to notify the Bureau in writing of any material change in any information filed with the Bureau not more than 30 days after such change occurs.

VOLUNTARY REGISTRATIONS: Organizations, that are not required to register with the Bureau, may do so voluntarily. If your organization is registering voluntarily, please check the appropriate box on the Registration Statement – Form BCO-10. Organizations, that elect to voluntarily register, must comply with **all** the Act's requirements with the exception of the payment of late filing fees.

INTERNALLY PREPARED, COMPILED, REVIEWED, OR AUDITED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS: Internally prepared financial statements shall contain a balance sheet and statement of revenue, expenses and changes in fund balances. Compiled financial statements must be prepared by a **licensed certified public accountant or licensed public accountant** in accordance with Statements on Standards for Accounting and Review Services issued by the American Institute of Certified Public Accountants. Reviews and audits **must be performed by an independent, licensed public accountant or an independent, licensed certified public accountant.** Reviews must be performed in accordance with the American Institute of Certified Public Accountants' Statements on Standards for Accounting and Review Services. Audits must be performed in accordance with the American Institute of Certified Public Accountants' Statements on Auditing Standards.

RETENTION OF RECORDS: Organizations are required to keep true and accurate fiscal records regarding their solicitation activities in Pennsylvania and must make these records available for inspection upon demand by the Bureau of the Office of Attorney General. These records must be retained for at least three years after the end of the period to which they relate.

AFFILIATE AND PARENT ORGANIZATIONS: An affiliate whose parent organization is located in Pennsylvania can register individually or its parent organization can file a combined registration for itself and its Pennsylvania affiliate(s). To file a combined registration, the Pennsylvania-based parent and each affiliate must file a separate Charitable Organization Registration Statement - Form BCO-10 and its own IRS 990 Return or a Form BCO-23 (see "Instructions"). An affiliate whose parent organization files a combined registration on its behalf does not have to pay a registration fee. However, the parent organization's registration fee is determined by combining the gross contributions received by the parent and all Pennsylvania affiliates. In addition, a parent organization filing a combined registration must submit the appropriate financial statements covering itself and all its Pennsylvania affiliates.